SOCIAL REFORMERS OF THE 19TH CENTURY

Class 8 History | Sample notes

1. RAJA RAM MOHAN ROY – Social reformer (1772–1833)

- Founded the **Brahmo Samaj** in 1828.
- Campaigned against **Sati**, which was banned in 1829.
- Supported **Western education** and English schools.
- Roy is called the **Father of the Indian Renaissance**.

2. ISHWAR CHANDRA VIDYASAGAR – Educationist and reformer (1820–1891)

- Worked to improve the lives of **widows**.
- His efforts led to the **Widow Remarriage Act** of 1856.
- Opened many **schools for girls** in Bengal.
- Vidyasagar was a title meaning **ocean of learning**.

3. JYOTIRAO PHULE – Social reformer (1827–1890)

- Fought against **caste** discrimination.
- Started a school for girls in **Pune** in 1848 with his wife **Savitribai Phule**.
- Founded the **Satyashodhak Samaj** in 1873.

QUICK COMPARISON

- Raja Ram Mohan Roy = Brahmo Samaj + end of Sati
- Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar = Widows + girls' schools
- Jyotirao Phule = Against caste + Satyashodhak Samaj